Anand Mathew

PhD Candidate in Economics
University of Florida

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Education

University of Florida, PhD in Economics Advisor: Ignacia Mercadal	2022 – May 2027 (expected)
University of Florida, MA in Economics	2024
South Asian University, New Delhi, Master of Economics (Development Economics)	2020
St. Stephen's College, University of Delhi, BA (Hons) in Economics	2018

Fields

Primary: Development Economics, Household Finance
Secondary: Environmental Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Job Market Paper

Credit Where Credit Is Withdrawn: Weather Shocks and the Household Coping Portfolio in India
with Sankalp Mathur (CAFRAL)

In September 2018 the default of Infrastructure Leasing and Financial Services, an infrastructure financier rated AAA weeks earlier, cut the wholesale funding of India's non-bank lenders. The squeeze was hardest in the districts that relied on them. We use it to ask what a contraction in formal credit does to the way households absorb a dry shock. We follow 210,560 households from 2014 to 2019 and set them beside 483 million loan records from the credit bureau, aggregated to the same districts. A dry shock takes the same share of income whether exposure to the contraction was higher or lower. Total spending barely moves in either case, but the composition of the basket differs. Where exposure was lower, the cuts begin with recreation and restaurant meals and stop before health, education and a staple such as milk. Where it was higher, the same shock reaches all three. Fewer households hold a non-bank loan, and among those who lose formal access, about as many stop borrowing as keep or find an informal lender. Few households borrow from a non-bank directly, so the effect runs through the district's credit market. Credit does not stop a dry shock from being felt. It determines how far down the coping portfolio a household has to go.

Working Papers

Freezing the Guarantee: Work, Credit and Welfare After India's Job Scheme Stopped in West Bengal
with Sankalp Mathur (CAFRAL)

Cannabis Access and College Persistence: Evidence from Washington State's Dispensary Lottery

Presentations

Southern Economic Association, 96th Annual Meeting, Houston (scheduled) Nov 2026
World Inequality Conference, Paris School of Economics Jun 2026
Southern Economic Association, 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa Nov 2025
WATE-Florida Workshop Oct 2025

Discussant
WATE-Florida Workshop, "Student Debt and Aggregate Consumption" Oct 2025

Fellowships and Awards

Madelyn Lockhart Doctoral Student Travel Award, University of Florida (three awards) 2025, 2026

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, University of Florida
ECO 4421 Econometrics (undergraduate) Fall 2025, Fall 2026

Teaching Assistant, University of Florida
Econometrics and Data Analysis (undergraduate and graduate) 2024 – 2026
Game Theory and Industrial Organization (undergraduate and graduate) 2022 – 2024
Public Economics, Managerial Economics, Macroeconomics, Microeconomics 2023 – 2026

Research and Professional Experience

Research Assistant to Douglas Turner, University of Florida Summer 2026
Research Assistant to Scott Kostyshak, University of Florida Spring 2024
Research Assistant to Gunnar Heins and Ignacia Mercadal, University of Florida Summer 2023
Research Assistant, Schumacher Centre Society, New Delhi 2020 – 2022
Research Intern, DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India 2019 – 2020
Survey Coordinator, National Food Security Act survey led by Jean Drèze and Reetika Khera 2016

Software and Languages

Software: R, Stata, Snowflake Cortex AI, LaTeX, Google Maps geocoding and distance APIs

Languages: English, Hindi

References

Ignacia Mercadal (Advisor)
Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Florida
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CAFRAL, Mumbai
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Douglas Turner
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